



*Millipedes are vegetarians and eat only
dead and rotting plants.*

Millipede

Around 420 million years ago, millipedes left the oceans and became some of the first creatures to walk on land. It's a good job these creepy-crawlies don't have to get dressed in the morning, because they have more legs than any other animals. The record is 375 pairs of legs, but 50–100 pairs is more usual.

The body of a millipede has many joints, so it's as bendy as a worm and can curl into a ball to protect itself. Some millipedes also release a horrid stink to put off predators. Others make a deadly poison that smells of toasted almonds, but is strong enough to kill birds or burn human skin.

